

Chapter 47-1

Xu Qingzhu saw Bai Weiwei's message just as she closed her computer, planning to leave work.

What first caught her eye was a bunch of photos, followed by those words.

After saying all that, she wanted to reply, but the message she sent out had a red exclamation mark in front of it.

Bai Weiwei had blocked her.

This matter was quite ridiculous when you thought about it.

Bai Weiwei had specifically removed her from the blacklist just to say this.

Not knowing what kind of intention she had, it was all quite speechless.

After dinner, Xu Qingzhu reminded Liang Shi to be careful.

She might be secretly photographed in the future.

Liang Shi was startled, "I really didn't do anything to betray you."

"I know." Xu Qingzhu said, "But some media will make up stories based on photos."

Liang Shi: "..."

She was silent for a few seconds, then said helplessly, "I'll be careful to keep my distance in the future."

It clearly hadn't been too long since she left that circle. The days of being followed and secretly photographed on the way home, downstairs, and at hotel entrances hadn't passed that long ago, but when Liang Shi thought about it now, it felt as distant as a century.

Those days seemed very far away from her now.

Regarding Cheng Ran's matter, Liang Shi didn't say much, so Xu Qingzhu didn't ask either.

Dinner was takeout that Xu Qingzhu had brought home, just needing to be warmed up in the microwave.

This was a relatively friendly approach for Xu Qingzhu, who couldn't cook.

After dinner, it was Liang Shi who washed the dishes while Xu Qingzhu sat on the living room sofa continuing to work.

She seemed to have endless things to keep her busy.

After Liang Shi finished washing the dishes, seeing her frowning deeply, she didn't go out to disturb her. Instead, she took some fruit from the refrigerator, washed a plate of fruit, and brought it out.

Even the action of placing it on the coffee table was very gentle.

When Xu Qingzhu finished her work, she sat there chatting casually with Liang Shi.

Somehow, they started talking about Qi Jiao's situation and then moved on to Rainbow. Liang Shi said she had been lectured by a five-year-old child.

Hearing this, Xu Qingzhu raised an eyebrow, "Tell me about it."

Liang Shi then told Xu Qingzhu about Rainbow's remarks from today, and finally asked, "Do you think it's the adults who are strange, or this little child who's strange?"

"This little child." Xu Qingzhu paused for a moment, then after a long while found a word to describe her, "Very smart."

"Yes, last time when she watched a sci-fi movie with me, she guessed the character logic and story direction very accurately." Liang Shi said, "And she was watching it in full English."

"Is she mixed-race?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

"Yes." Liang Shi said.

"Mixed-race children are indeed a bit smarter than ordinary children." Xu Qingzhu said, "But I think her remarks are quite valid."

As someone who had been hurt in childhood, Xu Qingzhu reflected on her own feelings back then. After a long while, she said in a low voice, "Harm won't disappear just because you don't look at it."

"But she's just a little child." Liang Shi said, "Isn't protecting children supposed to be adults' responsibility? At her age, she should be carefree, only worrying about what to eat and drink each day."

Xu Qingzhu glanced at her, "What about when you encounter irresponsible parents?"

Liang Shi: "..."

She was silent for a moment, then said, "Irresponsible parents wouldn't teach children these things either."

Xu Qingzhu nodded, "So children still have to grow up on their own. These are truths they'll have to understand sooner or later. Knowing them earlier is definitely better than knowing them later, right?"

Liang Shi sighed, "But these things are too painful for little children."

Hearing this, Xu Qingzhu looked at her with a meaningful gaze.

Liang Shi suddenly felt uneasy, "Why... why are you looking at me like that?"

Xu Qingzhu pressed her temples and said very seriously, "Promise me, if you have children in the future, please don't teach them yourself, okay?"

Liang Shi: "Huh? Why?"

Xu Qingzhu smiled, "You'll spoil them rotten."

This was clearly a future daughter-doting father¹ in training.

Liang Shi: "..."

She said in a low voice, "I don't have children yet. It's too early to think about these things."

Xu Qingzhu: "Planning ahead."

Liang Shi belatedly realized - so... what were they discussing?

How to educate children in the future?

Footnotes: ¹ Daughter-doting father (女兒奴): A Chinese term referring to fathers who are extremely protective and indulgent toward their daughters, often spoiling them.

Chapter 47-2

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The sun passed through the gaps in the curtains, and the light refracted into the room contained dancing dust particles, like leaping life.

A morning no different from usual.

After Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu had breakfast, they each left for work.

Before leaving, Xu Qingzhu remembered she needed to go to the study to collect some documents, so Liang Shi left first.

The autumn morning sunlight was warm and pleasant. Basking in it felt very comfortable. She leaned against the car with her eyes half-closed, her entire body bathed in sunlight.

When Xu Qingzhu hurriedly came out, she called out, "There's still time, no rush."

Xu Qingzhu responded that she knew, opened the car door, threw her bag and documents into the car, then turned and walked toward her.

Liang Shi asked, "What's wrong?"

Xu Qingzhu looked up at her, "Extend your hand."

Though puzzled, Liang Shi obediently extended her hand.

An Alpha's hands were slightly larger, mainly with longer fingers.

Liang Shi's hands were very white and tender.

These hands were more delicate than her original body's hands - after all, they belonged to someone who had never done rough work since childhood.

In her original world, she had done too many things. Even after becoming an actress and starting to pay attention to maintenance, she still couldn't compare to someone pampered from birth.

Her palm felt very warm under the sunlight.

A yellow talisman fell into her palm. Liang Shi was surprised, "How did it end up with you?"

Xu Qingzhu said helplessly, "You climbed such a high mountain to get this peace talisman, and you just lost it?"

"It was an accident." Liang Shi smiled sheepishly, "I had been wearing it on my body before."

"I picked it up in the entryway." Xu Qingzhu said. Seeing her casually stuff the peace talisman into her pocket, she couldn't help but frown, "You're just going to put it there like that?"

"Yes." Liang Shi said, "Don't you just need to keep this thing on your body?"

Then she asked, "Where did you put yours?"

Xu Qingzhu lifted her outer coat, revealing a yellow peace talisman pinned to her shirt shoulder.

Her shirt was also light yellow though, so with the color transition, it didn't look too ugly.

But Liang Shi's shirt was white.

Suddenly putting a peace talisman on it would look ugly, so she didn't really want to.

But Xu Qingzhu reached out and asked for her peace talisman, helping her pin it to her shoulder while telling her what her family's old lady used to say.

"My grandmother said, either don't believe at all - whether it's gods, Buddhas, ghosts, or spirits, as long as you don't believe, you won't encounter them. But if you do believe, especially if you've asked for talismans and statues, then you must treat them seriously, otherwise no one knows what kind of consequences there might be."

Xu Qingzhu was slightly shorter than Liang Shi. When helping her attach the peace talisman, her expression was serious, but the warm breath from her speech passed through the shirt and fell on the skin in front of Liang Shi.

Making her heart beat faster.

She did it quickly and efficiently. Even though the peace talisman contained something unknown that felt like sand when pinched, Xu Qingzhu had a way to make it completely invisible from the outside.

After finishing, she smoothed out the wrinkles on her coat, "If you think it's ugly, just don't take off your jacket."

Liang Shi looked down and indeed saw no trace of it.

She couldn't help but praise, "You're amazing."

Xu Qingzhu smiled and said nothing.

Chapter 47-3

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Liang Shi arrived at the company at 8:49.

She could probably arrive at her workstation five minutes early - she had calculated the timing precisely.

After parking her car, she walked toward the office building, but happened to run into Liang Xinzhou at the entrance.

In the past, she had seen Liang Xinhe more often at the company, but this was the first time seeing Liang Xinzhou.

Yesterday when she went upstairs to deliver a peace talisman to him, she unexpectedly learned that he was on a business trip.

At that time, his secretary told her his return date was uncertain.

She hadn't expected to encounter him downstairs at the company today. She immediately called out, "President Liang."

Liang Xinzhou stopped and turned around.

Compared to Liang Xinhe, Liang Shi was more afraid of Liang Xinzhou.

His features were deep-set, those eyes like impenetrable black holes. Always in a suit, he never smiled casually.

And all the trouble caused by the original owner had been cleaned up by Liang Xinzhou.

The two of them had argued quite a few times before. Several times the original owner's mouth was too sharp, making Liang Xinzhou so angry he almost resorted to violence.

But at critical moments, he would always stop himself.

Then the next time the original owner caused trouble, he would once again dutifully clean up after her.

Sure enough, Liang Xinzhou frowned when he saw her.

Liang Shi jogged a couple steps over to him, showing a brilliant smile, "Good morning!"

The advantage of being an actress was probably being able to show friendliness to people anytime, anywhere.

As the saying goes, you don't hit someone who's smiling at you.

Liang Shi smiled so brilliantly that Liang Xinzhou couldn't continue keeping a stern face. He relaxed slightly, but still got straight to the point, "What's the matter?"

"You're back from your business trip?" Liang Shi asked first.

"Mm." Liang Xinzhou felt that something abnormal must be brewing, so he asked again, "What trouble did you cause this time?"

To require such flattery from her, it must be at the level of murder and arson.

Liang Xinzhou's heart was already experiencing a downpour, his brow furrowed into a small mountain.

Liang Shi said helplessly, laughing lightly, "I've been at the company recently, what trouble could I cause? I'm just saying hello."

Liang Xinzhou: "..."

He looked at Liang Shi in bewilderment, his eyes conveying just one message - have you gone crazy?

That shocked expression seemed to say - do you think I believe you?

Liang Shi: "..."

The impression the original owner had given people couldn't be changed overnight.

However, last time when Liang Xinzhou defended her in front of Zhou Yi'an, Liang Shi was still very grateful.

Although he did it for his "sister," she was the one who benefited.

So following her principle of "repaying kindness," Liang Shi took out the peace talisman, "I went mountain climbing with colleagues on Sunday and got this for you. They say it's very effective."

Liang Xinzhou stared at her, never taking the thing.

After a few seconds, he said quietly, "Since when do you believe in these things?"

Liang Shi: "..."

She said sheepishly, "Better to believe than not believe, right? Since I climbed all the way up there."

"You never used to go to those places." Liang Xinzhou said, "And... you used to say those things were all scams."

"Huh?" Liang Shi awkwardly pinched her earlobe, "Did I say that?"

Her Best Actress acting skills were displayed to the fullest at this moment, "I don't remember. Anyway, I got it for you, so just use it. If you don't want to use it, just put it in your office drawer."

Liang Xinzhou was half-believing, half-doubting, then thought of another possibility, "Are you out of money?"

Liang Shi: "...!"

Her eyes immediately widened as she quickly denied, "No! I have money, lots of money."

...

After saying this, she shocked herself - those words had too much of a nouveau riche¹ flavor.

So Liang Shi quickly tried to remedy it, "Second brother gave me money before, and I have a salary, you don't need to give me money."

She was afraid Liang Xinzhou was also the type to transfer money without a word.

If that happened, the more she owed, what would she pay back with?

She would have to leave the Liang family sooner or later.

She was a fake heiress, but these two were real young masters.

Liang Shi was clear in her heart that no matter what, they were the real family members.

The two real young masters couldn't possibly fall out with their biological mother because of her, an outsider.

So it was better to owe less debt.

Liang Shi's mental abacus was clicking loudly.

She looked at her watch, "Alright, if I don't go up now I'll be late. Big brother, you should hurry up too."

With that, she placed the peace talisman in his hand and walked straight ahead.

Liang Xinzhou stood in place, completely puzzled.

Liang Shi heard his assistant say, "How is Third Miss like a completely different person?"

Liang Xinzhou: "You think so too?"

"She can actually come to work this early." The assistant said, "It's practically a miracle."

Liang Xinzhou: "..."

"She was just lazy before." Liang Xinzhou said coldly, "It's not like she can't do anything. Now she seems to be doing quite well."

The secretary voiced agreement.

Hearing this, Liang Shi felt mixed emotions.

These two brothers really had deep rose-colored glasses².

And you could tell they were real brothers - both equally tsundere³.

Footnotes: ¹ Nouveau riche (暴发户): Refers to people who have recently acquired wealth and tend to display it ostentatiously ² Rose-colored glasses: Meaning they viewed her too positively/favorably ³ Tsundere: A personality type that appears cold or hostile on the surface but is actually caring underneath

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Liang Shi hadn't walked far when she suddenly remembered that she was going back to the old mansion tonight. Afraid of making a wasted trip, she turned back to ask Liang Xinzhou, "Big brother, are mom and dad at home recently?"

Liang Xinzhou looked puzzled, but still told her, "They're there."

"That's good." Liang Shi said, "I haven't seen mom in a long time. How is her health?"

Liang Xinzhou: "..."

His tone was unfriendly, "You could just go back and see for yourself, wouldn't you know then? After getting married, you come home less and less frequently, and you still have the nerve to ask?"

Liang Shi smiled sheepishly and said nothing.

Was it that she didn't want to go back?

It was that she couldn't go back!

That room - staying in it for half an hour made her feel chills down her spine, as if something was following her.

Liang Shi took this opportunity to ask again, "So big brother, have you been to my room?"

Liang Xinzhou was even more puzzled, "Your room is locked so tightly, who could get in? Besides, you're not even there, what would I go to your room for?"

Liang Shi: "...Oh."

She continued asking, "You've never gone in, not even once?"

Liang Xinzhou found her strange, but still patiently answered, "Since you were sixteen and had your room renovated, I haven't been in. Mom said no one was allowed in. Did you forget?"

Liang Shi: "..."

She coughed lightly, "I remember, I remember."

Her answer carried a slight tone of gritted teeth.

Qiu Zimin was really deceiving everyone!

No, she might be deceiving several parties - she had more schemes than hairs on her head.

So no one knew that the original owner's room had been arranged like that, and no one knew that the original owner's room had been arranged like that.

Moreover, Liang Xinzhou said the original owner's room was renovated when she was sixteen.

This explained the youthful state in that photograph.

But the ritual in the original owner's memo appeared on July 15th, 2020.

There was a gap of several years in between.

What did this mean again?

Liang Shi was already used to this feeling of being completely in the dark. She didn't force herself to understand, and seeing that time was running short, she immediately said, "Big brother, I'm going to work first."

Just as she was about to turn around, she saw a person wearing black clothes and a mask hurriedly walking in their direction.

She paused, feeling something was wrong.

The person slightly raised their head, revealing a fierce look in their eyes.

"Go ahead." Liang Xinzhou said.

Just as he finished speaking, they saw the person pull out a knife from somewhere. The cold light flashed immediately. Liang Shi's pupils contracted in shock as she immediately said, "Be careful..."

Before she could finish her words, her body moved faster than her mouth. She grabbed Liang Xinzhou and pulled him away, but her body spun with the momentum, exposing her back to the opponent.

Everyone in the office building was frightened by this incident and didn't react immediately.

Only Liang Shi moved extremely quickly, but that person was obviously no pushover either, using the knife with tremendous force.

The knife didn't hit Liang Xinzhou, but slashed across Liang Shi's shoulder.

The sharp blade cut through skin and flesh, blood immediately seeped out, staining the light-colored suit jacket she was wearing red.

But Liang Shi couldn't care about the pain. She directly reached out to block the man's pressing arm, while her other hand twisted behind him. In the blink of an eye, she used her positional advantage to perform a shoulder throw on the man.

Thud!

Clang!

After the man fell to the ground, his arm was simultaneously dislocated by Liang Shi's force, and the knife fell directly to the ground a meter away.

The blade was stained with bright red blood, looking sinister as it lay on the ground.

The moment he tried to get up, Liang Shi immediately ran over and pinned him to the ground, restraining his shoulders.

A female Alpha's strength was not to be underestimated, but this male Alpha seemed to have a death wish, his strength surprisingly great.

Liang Shi used all her strength, causing her wound to tear open further, blood flowing non-stop. Her neck and face were flushed red, and her expression was far from beautiful.

It was Liang Xinzhou who reacted first, immediately shouting at the group of security guards who had run over but didn't know where to start, "Are you all just watching the show?! Why don't you help!"

He said this while immediately going to pull Liang Shi.

Liang Shi didn't dare relax until those security guards had completely subdued the man.

This was the morning rush hour. The originally crowded elevator wasn't crowded anymore, as everyone was staring at this scene.

After it was all over, someone blinked, "Did I see that wrong?"

"Was that acting just now?"

"Are you crazy? Didn't you see someone got hurt?"

"But her moves were so cool, just like filming an action scene."

"If President Liang hears you, you're done for."

"..."

People whispered and discussed quietly on the side.

All wearing expressions of disbelief.

Liang Xinzhou immediately had someone prepare a car. He couldn't be bothered to deal with the person on the ground, had his secretary call the police, then pulled Liang Shi to the hospital.

Liang Shi instinctively smiled, "Big brother, it's nothing."

Even though the pain from her shoulder was somewhat unbearable, she still didn't want people to worry about her.

Liang Xinzhou frowned and said coldly, "Don't talk."

Liang Shi followed behind him, looking like she had done something wrong.

As they were leaving, they happened to encounter the late-arriving Liang Xinhe.

Seeing that Liang Shi's shoulder was bleeding so much, his face immediately changed color, "What happened?"

"Small matter, small matter." Liang Shi said, "Let's go to the hospital first."

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On the way to the hospital, Liang Shi sat in the back seat between her two brothers.

Liang Xinzhou made phone calls to handle the man from earlier and quickly figured out the reason.

It was a company they had previously invested in. That man was the company's legal representative who had become addicted to gambling and nearly turned the company into an empty shell. Fortunately, they discovered it in time and recovered their investment.

As a result, he became desperate and came directly to the company to take revenge on Liang Xinzhou.

After learning the reason, Liang Xinhe couldn't help but frown, "I told you before, there's no need to invest in these small companies. They're all short-sighted people. Even if we invest in them, they won't be of much help to us."

"If we hadn't invested in Haicheng Culture back then, we wouldn't have so much liquid capital now." Liang Xinzhou said, "Everything has pros and cons. Times have changed."

Liang Xinhe sighed, "What about when we encounter this kind of situation? Someone could die if we're not careful."

"Second brother, I'm really fine." Liang Shi sat in the middle, trembling with fear that the two might start fighting. She spoke softly to mediate, "Who could have known this kind of thing would happen?"

Hearing this, Liang Xinhe glanced at her, "Liang Shi, do you really think your little flower fists and embroidery legs¹ can kill someone? You really just charge in when something happens."

Liang Shi: "..."

She immediately shrank like a quail.

"Big brother has practiced fencing for ten years and martial arts for fifteen years. Isn't he stronger than you? When is it your turn to step forward? Have you lived too long?" Liang Xinhe poked her head, "Really not afraid of death."

Liang Shi: "..."

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Liang Shi felt guilty the entire way.

When they arrived at the hospital, she discovered it was Zhao Xuning's hospital again. She suddenly remembered Zhao Xuning's words - don't come, there are no beds available.

Unfortunately, she still came.

Coming with Liang Xinzhou and the others meant special treatment.

The hospital director personally received them, arranged a VIP bed for her, and the doctor who treated her wound was an experienced chief physician.

The chief physician said her bone wasn't injured.

The peace talisman on her shoulder had broken into two halves, and whatever was stuffed inside was nowhere to be found - only two pieces of cloth remained.

If Xu Qingzhu hadn't pinned the peace talisman on her this morning, that knife might have cut through to her bone.

Only now did Liang Shi understand - workplace, bloody disaster.

That Taoist seemed to have some real ability.

The peace talisman had helped her ward off disaster. According to Li Ran, she should go back to Cloud Hidden Taoist Temple² to pay respects another day as a way of fulfilling her vow.

The chief physician was experienced in treating wounds, so Liang Shi didn't feel particularly painful during the process.

But having such a large gash on her body still hurt.

After the bandaging was complete, Liang Xinhe still asked worriedly, "Doctor, doesn't she need a tetanus shot or something?"

Hearing this made Liang Shi's eyelids twitch.

After that, she wanted to return to the company to work, but was ordered by the two men to stay in the hospital and rest.

So...

She looked at Zhao Xuning, spinning an apple in her hand, "Are you free?"

Zhao Xuning stood with her arms crossed by the table, directly across from her hospital bed at a distance of ten meters, "Not bad, not as free as you."

Liang Shi: "How about peeling an apple?"

Zhao Xuning: "I don't eat them."

Liang Shi: "...I'll eat it."

She was indeed bored.

So bored that she actually wanted to eat an apple and tease Zhao Xuning.

Mainly because there wasn't much fun to be had in this hospital room.

She wanted to go to work.

Of course, Zhao Xuning didn't peel the apple for her.

In Zhao Xuning's words, my knife is used to cut people open. If you need that, I can help you.

Liang Shi: "..."

She felt it was better not to risk her life.

However, Zhao Xuning reluctantly washed it for her.

Liang Shi ate the apple with its skin on while boredly turning on the TV.

The TV was showing a large-scale documentary, which she used as background noise to help her sleep.

Not long after, Zhao Ying came to see her. They chatted for a while, and Zhao Ying told her a lot of industry gossip, and also mentioned the time for the costume fitting photos.

It was this Saturday.

Footnotes: ¹ Flower fists and embroidery legs (花拳繡腿): An idiom meaning superficial martial arts skills that look good but are not practical in real combat ² Cloud Hidden Taoist Temple (雲隱道觀): A fictional Taoist temple where they went to pray for the peace talismans

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Zhao Ying also said, "I know you usually have to work, so I specifically asked them to find a suitable time."

Liang Shi smiled, "Sister Ying is so thoughtful."

"But your injury..." Zhao Ying was worried, "Will you be able to do makeup and styling then?"

"I can." Liang Shi said, "Don't let the tight bandaging fool you - it's just a small wound. If we hadn't come to the hospital so early, it might have healed by now."

Zhao Xuning, who had seen her wound, said: "Heh."

Liang Shi: "..."

Before leaving, Zhao Ying also patted Zhao Xuning, "Don't bully Xiao Liang¹ just because she's injured. You're always wearing such a stern face - who owes you money?"

Zhao Xuning replied without hesitation, "You."

Zhao Ying: "..."

"How many years ago was that?" Zhao Ying said, "Am I the type of person who doesn't pay back money?"

"You are." Zhao Xuning said, "When are you going to return my five hundred?"

Zhao Ying gritted her teeth, "I'm not giving it back."

"Then I'll ask Yang Shuyan for it." Zhao Xuning said.

Zhao Ying's eyes immediately widened, "Hey, if you're going to be like that, now I'm interested."

Zhao Xuning slightly raised an eyebrow, "Hmm?"

"I still have Shen Hui's WeChat." Zhao Ying said, "How about I introduce you two?"

Zhao Xuning: "..."

The hospital room fell into an eerie silence.

The two cousins bickered with each other, and in the end Zhao Xuning admitted defeat. She pushed Zhao Ying out, "Go film your drama properly."

Zhao Ying showed a victorious smile, but said meaningfully with a sigh, "Our aloof flower² also has someone she's afraid of. Unbelievable!"

Zhao Xuning: "..."

Her thin lips parted slightly as she unhurriedly uttered one word: "Scram."

"Huh?" Zhao Ying clung to the doorframe, "What did you say? You want me to find Shen Hui?"

Zhao Xuning: "...Enough already."

Zhao Ying laughed, "Who would have thought? My sister has fallen just like that."

Zhao Xuning: "..."

After Zhao Ying left, Liang Shi looked toward Zhao Xuning.

She had only intended to check Zhao Xuning's expression, but the moment her gaze fell on her, Zhao Xuning said, "Don't ask, don't know, won't tell."

Liang Shi: "..."

Ah, this.

Looks like there's definitely something there.

And just from their bickering earlier, you could tell that Zhao Ying and Yang Shuyan also had something going on.

In that instant, what Liang Shi thought of was - Xu Qingzhu's house of cards³ has collapsed!

Footnotes: ¹ Xiao Liang (小梁): A familiar/affectionate way of addressing Liang Shi, with "xiao" meaning "little" or "young" ² Aloof flower (高嶺之花): A metaphor for someone who is beautiful but cold and unapproachable, like a flower on a high mountain peak ³ House of cards (塌房): Internet slang meaning when someone's perfect image or reputation suddenly collapses due to scandals or revelations

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Zhao Xuning had just come to check on her during her afternoon shift break and left soon after.

In the empty hospital room, only the TV's sound remained. After the documentary finished, there were commercials - long commercials followed by the afternoon news broadcast.

Liang Shi was bored to death and chatted randomly with Li Ran and the others in their group chat for a while.

The rainbow fart¹ compliments were too much - she was almost blown away by all the flattery.

Fortunately, she still retained a thread of rationality.

Liang Shi exited the group chat and found many unread messages, all just sent.

【Xu Qingzhu: You're injured? Is it serious?】

【Sally: OMG, Liang Shi, you've refreshed my understanding of you again.】

【Sally: Have you practiced martial arts? Kung fu!】

【Sally: So cool! Can you teach me in the future?】

【Sally: Oh right, Blanche asked me to ask how serious your injury is?】

【Sally: It doesn't look very serious.】

Sally's chatterbox nature was fully exposed at this moment.

Even through the screen, you could imagine her excited appearance.

Liang Shi was about to reply when she had just typed one character, but Xu Qingzhu's video call popped up.

She swiped to answer.

On the other end of the video, Xu Qingzhu was sitting in her office with a cup of hot water beside her, still steaming with misty vapor.

Through the video, it made her look ethereal and fairy-like.

"Are you okay?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Liang Shi shook her head, "I'm fine, except it's a bit boring in the hospital."

"What about the wound?" Xu Qingzhu said, "Let me see."

Liang Shi turned the camera to her shoulder, then told her, "You know what? It was amazing. That person slashed right where the peace talisman was. The talisman had something inside, right? The doctor said it was filled with buckwheat husks², so the knife didn't go very deep. It's just that my brother was worried and had the doctor bandage it very thoroughly."

Xu Qingzhu quietly listened to her talk.

Only after Liang Shi finished did she notice something was wrong. She sniffled, "What's wrong?"

Xu Qingzhu's gaze swept over coolly, but with extreme pressure. Even her words carried a hint of sarcasm, "I just think Teacher Liang should be awarded a medal for acting bravely."

Liang Shi: "..."

"I'm already injured." Liang Shi pursed her lips, "Can you stop being sarcastic?"

Xu Qingzhu fell silent.

After a moment, that cool voice softened a bit, "What do you want for dinner?"

Liang Shi: "...I haven't even had lunch yet?"

Xu Qingzhu frowned, "What time is it now?"

Liang Shi was also aggrieved, "No one brought me food."

Just as she finished speaking, someone knocked on her hospital room door. A large group of people filed in, then set up tables and served food in front of her bed - more than ten dishes, large and small.

A message from Liang Xinzhou popped up on the screen: 【Order more if this isn't enough.】

Liang Shi: "..."

After the food delivery people left, Liang Shi very amicably discussed with Xu Qingzhu, "Tonight, I think we might have to eat leftovers. Are you okay with that?"

Xu Qingzhu: "...No."

Liang Shi was about to say something else when she saw the TV broadcasting a case where police had just cracked down on human trafficking in Dongling City. The criminals who had been on the run for many years were finally caught - it was truly satisfying news.

After reporting this news, they inserted two missing person segments.

One was about a 17-year-old boy from Chunling County looking for his family. He showed a birthmark on his shoulder, hoping his biological parents would see it and contact him.

The other was about a 25-year-old girl from Taozhi Village looking for her biological parents. She said her adoptive parents had both passed away, and her paralyzed grandmother had also recently died, leaving her alone in the world with no relatives. She hoped to find her parents.

Liang Shi had originally only been interested in the human trafficking case, but was stunned when she saw the second missing person segment.

The person in the video was called Guo Xinran, and she looked extremely similar to Qiu Zimin.

Footnotes: ¹ Rainbow fart (彩虹屁): Internet slang for excessive compliments or flattery, originally referring to colorful and exaggerated praise ² Buckwheat husks (荞麦皮): Commonly used as filling in traditional Chinese pillows and sometimes in small pouches or talismans